01 THE CORE IDEA

# AI agents turn goals into actions

An agent is an LLM-powered system that understands a goal, chooses actions, uses tools, observes results, and decides what to do next.

KEY MESSAGE

**An agent does more than generate text.** It works toward a goal through actions.

EXHIBIT 1 · THE AGENT LOOP

### Goal

Understand the desired outcome.

### Repeat or finish

Continue until the goal is met.




### Decide

Choose the next useful action.

### Act

Invoke a permitted tool.

### Observe

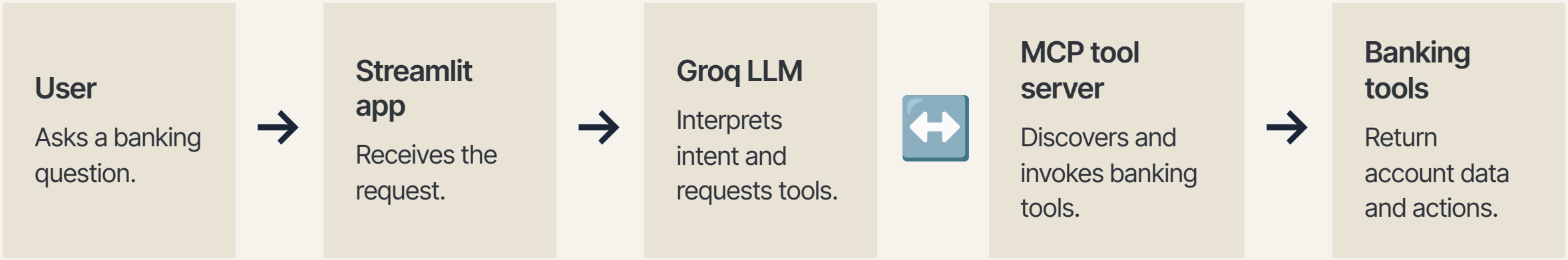
Read what happened.

A GOAL CREATES THE LOOP; TOOL USE MAKES THE LOOP ACTIONABLE.

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# Our banking assistant already has the building blocks

EXHIBIT 2 · CURRENT BANKING ASSISTANT ARCHITECTURE




EXAMPLE · ONE TOOL CALL

"What is my current balance?"

`get_account_balance`

The tool returns the result, which the assistant presents to the user.

OBSERVABILITY ACROSS THE FLOW

**Langfuse** observes prompts, tool calls, results, and evaluations across the assistant.

THE COMPONENTS EXIST ALREADY; THE AGENT LAYER CHANGES HOW THEY ARE COORDINATED.



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# Tool calling becomes agentic when decisions adapt

EXHIBIT 3 · TWO WORKFLOWS, DIFFERENT DECISION LOGIC

CONVENTIONAL TOOL CALLING

## A predefined sequence

1. Application sends the first tool request.
2. Application sends the next request.
3. Application formats the returned answer.

The path is designed in advance.

AGENT-DRIVEN WORKFLOW

## A goal-directed loop

Goal: “Review my recent transactions and tell me whether I spent more than £200.”

1. Determine what is needed.
2. Select the tools needed to review transactions.
3. Examine results and calculate the total.
4. Decide when there is enough evidence to answer.

The next step depends on what the system learns.

THE TEST FOR “AGENTIC”

**Multiple tools are not the distinction.** Adaptive, goal-directed decision-making is.

TOOL CALLING CAN USE MULTIPLE TOOLS AND STILL FOLLOW A FIXED SCRIPT.



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# Five capabilities make an agent workflow work

EXHIBIT 4 · CAPABILITIES AROUND ONE BANKING REQUEST

### Reasoning

Interpret the request and decide what is needed.

### Orchestration

Control routing, repetition, errors, and completion.




### Planning

Choose the next step or break the goal into subtasks.

### Tool execution

Invoke permitted tools through MCP.

### State and memory

Track the request, intermediate results, and progress.

REQUEST

**Review recent transactions and tell me whether I spent more than £200.**

APPLICATION GUARDRAILS

- Permissions
- Validation
- Stopping limits

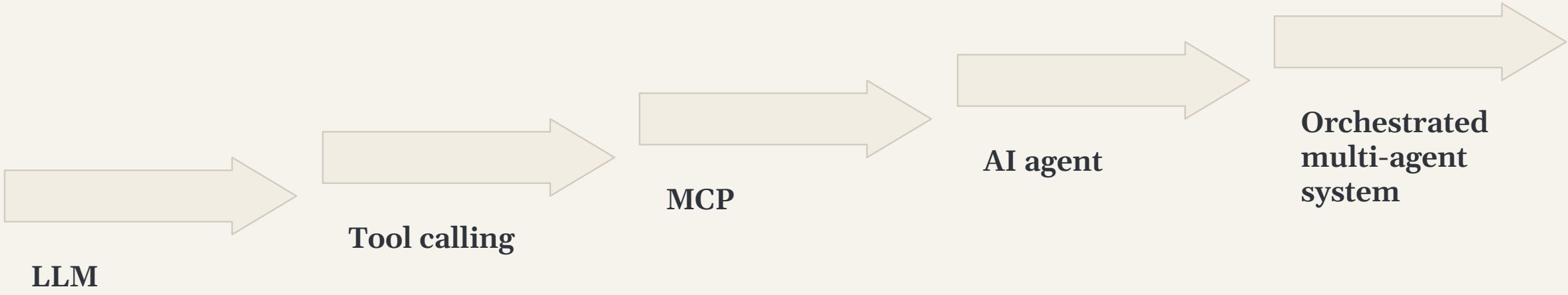
THE MODEL DECIDES; THE APPLICATION CONSTRAINS WHAT IT IS ALLOWED TO DO.



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# Use agents when the next action depends on what you learn

EXHIBIT 5 · FROM MODEL TO ORCHESTRATED SYSTEM




GOOD FIT

Useful for multi-step tasks, dynamic decisions, changing tool needs, and workflows shaped by intermediate results.

NEXT BANKING ENHANCEMENT

Move from answering one balance question to reviewing transactions and deciding when the evidence is sufficient.

**We are moving from building applications that answer questions to building applications that can work toward goals.**

Trade-off: agents add complexity, latency, cost, and risk. Simple workflows should remain simple.



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